Case study 6: Procurement decision memo

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SYNTHETIC Fictional procurement scenario for training only.

Scenario

A manager used AI to draft a memo recommending a solar equipment vendor for emergency deployment.

AI memo claims: “Vendor A (fictional) has ISO 9001 certification, delivered 500 units to UN agencies in 2025, and offers 48-hour delivery to Region Y.”

Your records: Vendor A is on the approved vendor list, but its ISO status is unverified. No record of UN deliveries. Standard lead time is 14 days.

Your task (10 minutes)

1. Which claims must be verified before procurement proceeds?
2. How would you mark each claim?
3. Green, amber, or red for using the memo in a approval workflow?
4. Who must sign procurement decisions?

Model answer

Claim	Status	Action
ISO 9001	Unverified	Request certificate from vendor
UN deliveries 2025	Unsupported	Remove or verify with references
48-hour delivery	Contradicts internal records	Confirm contract terms

Decision: Amber until verified. Red if memo is submitted as fact without checks.

Accountability: Named procurement officer and delegated authority per organizational policy. AI does not sign.

Common errors

- Trusting “sounds official” vendor credentials
- Skipping verification because of emergency pressure
- Letting AI rank vendors without disclosed criteria

Principle taught

Procurement integrity: AI can fabricate credentials and track records. Verification protects funds and affected populations depending on equipment.